

Cross-Cultural Collaboration and Planning in the Lawrence Partnership for Transition to Employment (LPTE)

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Overview

The Lawrence Partnership for Transition to Employment (LPTE) was launched in 2021. It uses a **collaborative, strengths-based, community-driven approach** in a traditionally underserved community to **improve the transition to adult life for local youth with ID/DD**.

Project Goals



“Colaborar, compartir y participar es la forma en que promovemos cambios positivos.”

(“Collaborating, sharing, and participating is the way we can promote positive changes.”)

– Patsy Navarrete, LPTE Consortium Member

Background

Lawrence, Massachusetts: Una Ciudad Latina

By the 2000 census, Lawrence was the **first Latino majority city in New England**.

“Latinos were responsible for reversing the city’s population decline; for filling its abandoned homes and buildings; for bringing life to its streets; churches, restaurants and parks; and for anchoring its tax base. **There can be no doubt that Latino migration was good for the city of Lawrence.**” (Barber, 2017, p. 217)

81% of Lawrence residents identify as Latino / Hispanic

78% speak a language other than English at home

Source: US Census, 2021

Lawrence Public Schools

Of students in special education:

93% of students are Latino / Hispanic

20% of students are in special education

69% had a first language other than English

41% were classified as English Language Learners

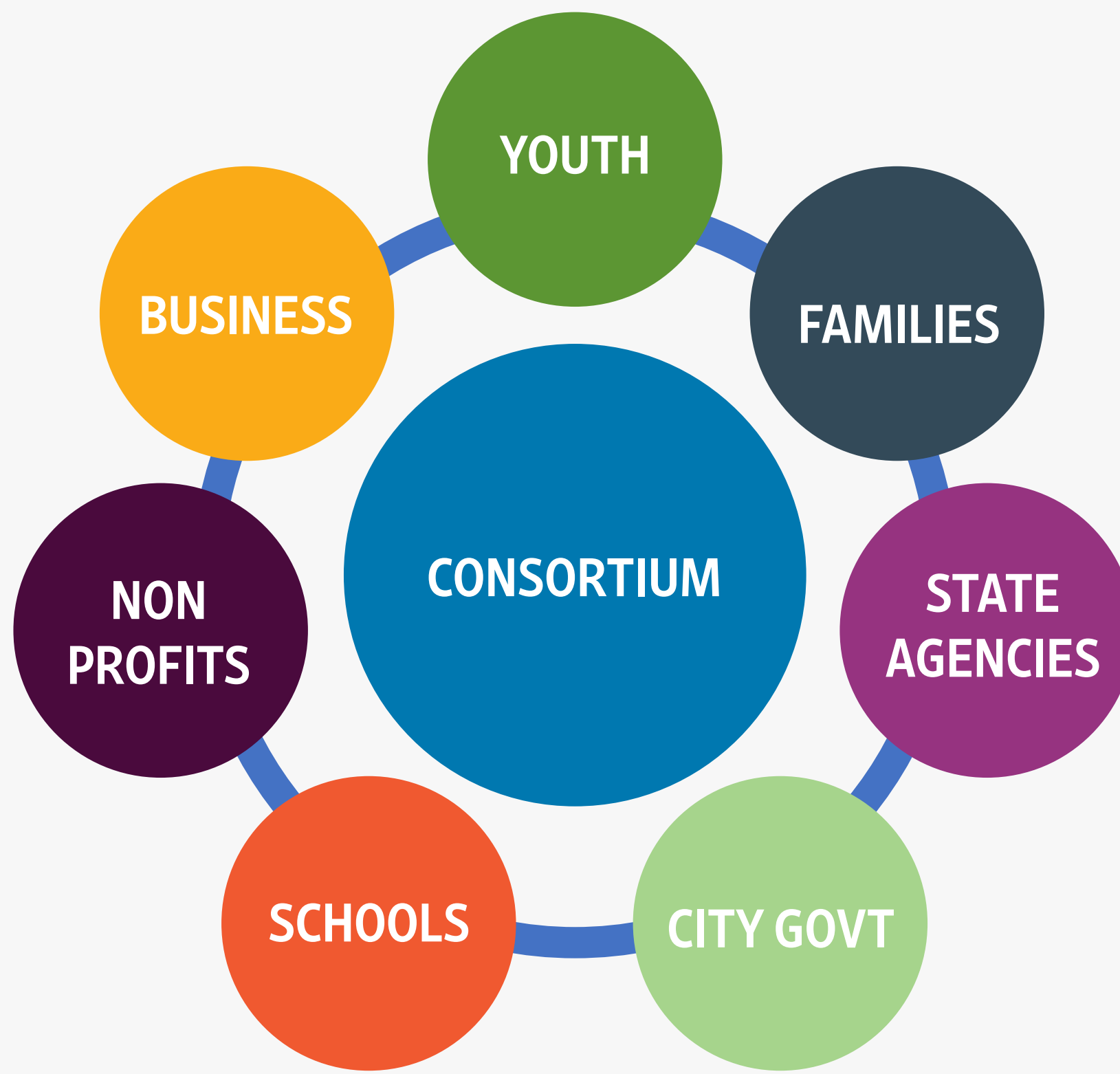
Source: MA Department of Elementary and Secondary Education, 2021; Lawrence Public Schools, 2020

2021

1. Establish LPTE Consortium

Guiding Principles: Collaborating for Equity and Justice

The LPTE is grounded in the 6 principles of Collaborating for Equity and Justice (Wolff et al. 2016). At each Consortium meeting, we present the principles in plain language (English and Spanish) and highlight one for discussion.



The six principles are:	LPTE will:
1. Directly address race, ethnicity, and social class.	Talk openly about these things, starting with this meeting.
2. Give equal power to community members in deciding what's important to work on.	Listen to parents, students, and other people in Lawrence when deciding what to put in our strategic plan.
3. Work to build leadership and power among community members.	Include parents and students as paid team members in all project work.
4. Focus on changing whole systems, not just local programs.	Learn from people in Lawrence how state and national policies can be better for families.
5. Look to research on what works.	Use existing tools to measure how we are doing.
6. Support the group members to lead the work.	Use ICI and Arc staff to support what the consortium wants to do.

2022-23

2. Conduct Community Landscape Analysis

Community Input

We held:

- » Quarterly Consortium meetings
- » Monthly Steering Committee meetings
- » 5 Community Conversations
- » 2 discussions with high school students
- » meeting with a parent group

We asked:

- » What outcomes do you think are important for youth with disabilities in Lawrence when they leave school?
- » What are 1 or 2 things that would help youth with disabilities find employment when they leave school?
- » What are 1 or 2 strengths within the Lawrence community that could help youth with disabilities find employment?
- » In four years, what services, supports, and opportunities for work would you like to see for youth with disabilities in your community?

Fall 2022 – Spring 2023

Virtual and in-person in Lawrence
Bilingual (Spanish and English)

KEY FINDINGS

Important Outcomes for Youth:

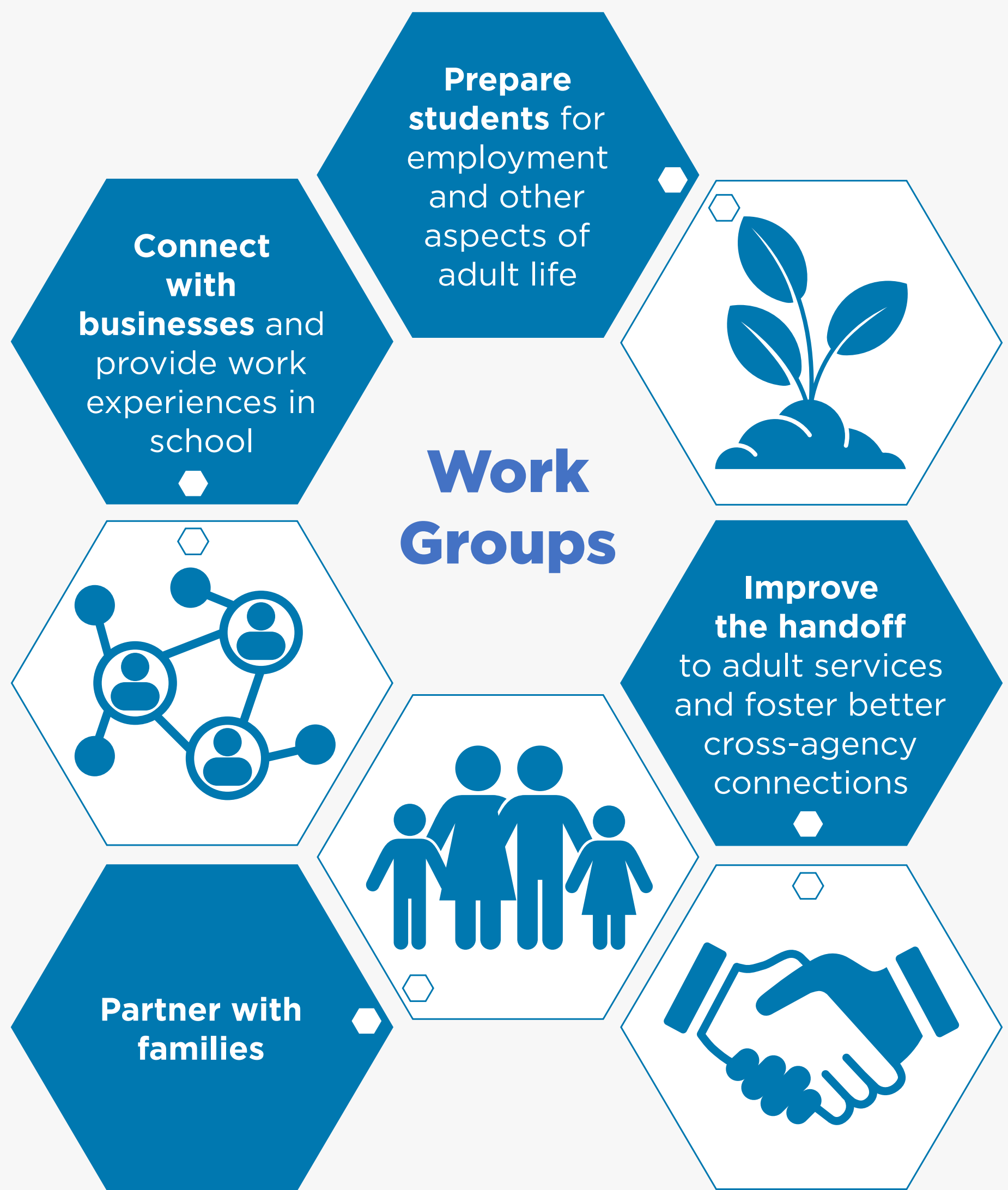
- Gaining skills
- Jobs and careers
- Necessary supports to meet their own life goals
- Community and relationships
- Confidence & independence

Strengths of the Community:

- Inclusive, supportive culture
- Personal strengths of youth with disabilities
- Lots of community resources
- Strong disability services
- Many large & small businesses
- Engaged parents

2023-24

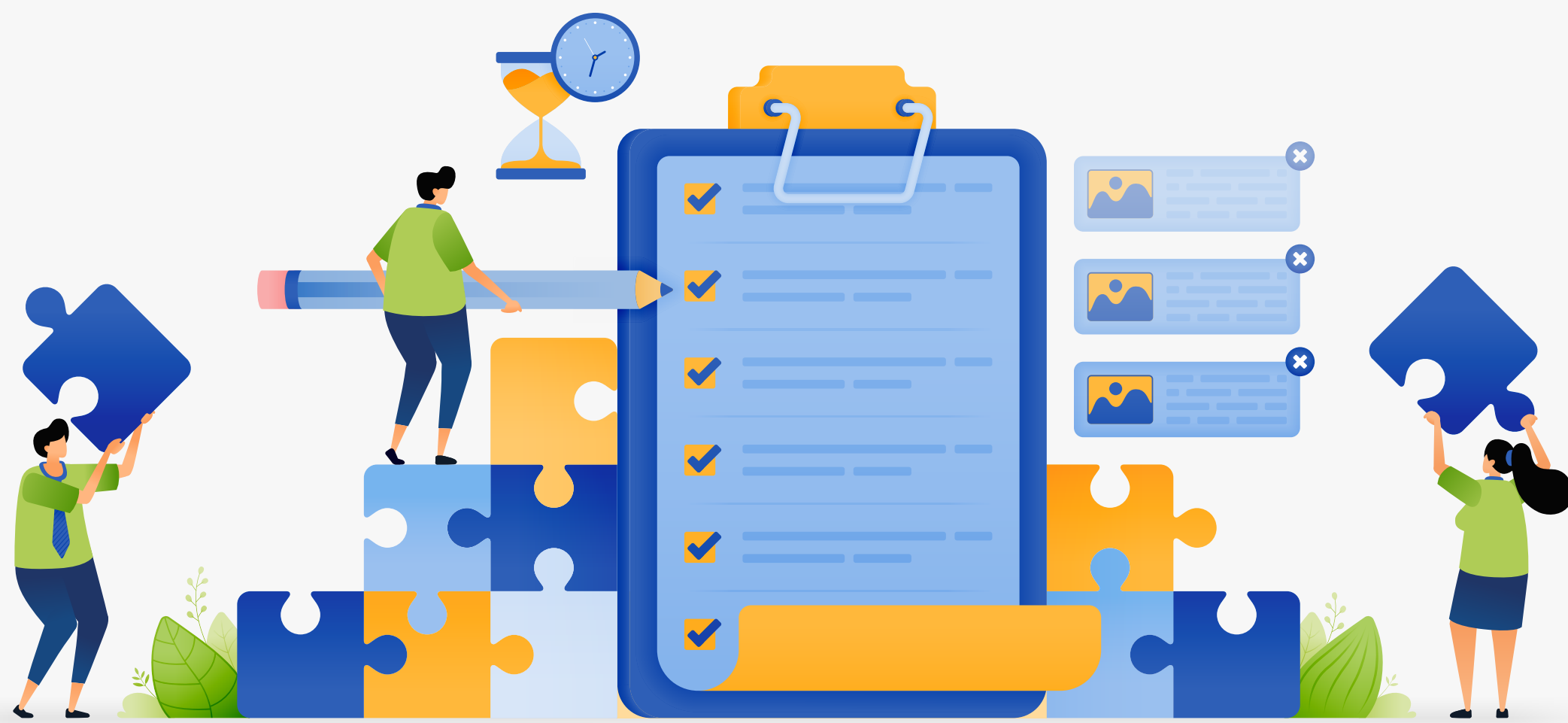
3. Strategic Planning



- » Led by Consortium members
- » Supported by LPTE staff
- » Kicked off at September 2023 Consortium Meeting

2024-26

4. Plan Implementation



Next Steps for Work Groups:

- » Meet monthly
- » Review priorities and strategies from the CLA
- » Develop plans with goals, objectives, and activities
- » Implement plans
- » Collaborate and communicate with each other



References

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